Roman Key Card Blackwood - 1430 version

RKCB is similar to Blackwood, but instead of four Aces there are Five Keycards. They are the Aces plus the King of the agreed trump suit. Starting with 4NT, a reply of 5♣ shows 1 or 4 Keycards, 5♦ shows 0 or 3, 5♥ shows 2 Keycards but no trump Queen, and 5♠ shows 2 Keycards with the trump Queen.
If your side has all five Keycards, bidding 5NT will repeat the process for Kings, remembering that there are only three Kings since the trump King is counted as a Keycard. There are two popular methods for responding to 5NT. The first is the same as normal Blackwood - 6♣ shows no Kings, 6♦ shows one, and 6♥ shows three. This is the method used in the recommended bidding here.
If the response to 4NT is 5♣ or 5♦ the 4NT bidder may choose to ask about the trump Queen rather than ask for Kings. She does this by bidding the cheapest non-trump suit. Partner denies the trump Queen by returning to the trump suit. A 5NT bid confirms the trump Queen, but shows no outside Kings. Bidding any non-trump suit confirms the trump Queen and also the King of the suit bid.
Void showing by Responder is handled just as in regular Blackwood except it refers to one or two Keycards, rather than one or two Aces.

Board: 1
Dealer: **South**

Contract: 7NT
Declarer: North
Lead: ♥6

Board: 2
Dealer: **West**

Contract: 6♠
Declarer: East
Lead: ♥K

Board: 3
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 6♠
Declarer: South
Lead: ♣Q

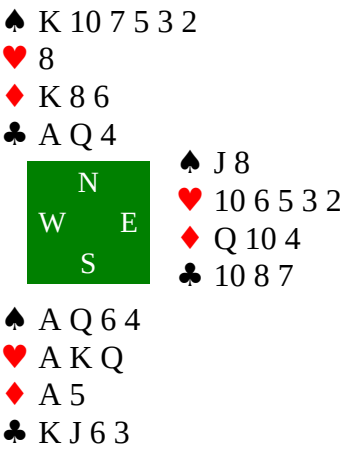
Board: 4
Dealer: **East**

Contract: 7NT
Declarer: West
Lead: ♠Q

Board: 5
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 5♠
Declarer: North
Lead: ♣4

Board 1
South Deals
None Vul



West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			2♣
Pass	2♠	Pass	3♠
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♦[2]
Pass	5♥	Pass	6♣
Pass	7NT		
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 0 or 3 key cards

7NT by North
Lead: ♥6

When SOUTH agrees to ♠s, NORTH will not stop short of a slam. The RKCB 4NT bid tells NORTH that they have all five Key Cards since SOUTH could hardly have a 2♣ opening hand with no Aces.

NORTH's 5♥ bid is the Queen Ask, and SOUTH's reply confirms that she holds the ♠Q, and also has the ♣K.

NORTH figures the ♠ suit will run, and this should be enough for Grand Slam. He chooses 7NT.

Board 2
West Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ 10 9 4 ♥ 10 9 6 2 ♦ 9 6 3 ♣ 9 3 2	
♠ Q 8 6 ♥ Q J 3 ♦ A J 5 ♣ A J 6 5		♠ A K 7 5 3 ♥ 8 ♦ K Q 7 2 ♣ K Q 4
	♠ J 2 ♥ A K 7 5 4 ♦ 10 8 4 ♣ 10 8 7	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
1NT	Pass	3♠	Pass
4♠	Pass	4NT[1]	Pass
5♠[2]	Pass	6♠	
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 2 key cards with the trump queen

6♠ by East
Lead: ♥K

EAST knows there are enough points for slam, but she is worried about the trump suit. WEST's support doesn't guarantee more than three ♠s, and if they are not headed by the Queen she could lose a trump trick.

Her RKCB bid relieves her mind when EAST claims two Key Cards PLUS the ♠Q. She bids 6♠ (and hopes for a 3-2 trump split!).

Board 3
North Deals
None Vul

♠ K 9 3
♥ A 10 6
♦ A 9 8 6 2
♣ K 9

♠ 8 7
♥ J 7 5
♦ 10 7 4 3
♣ Q J 7 3



♠ 10 4
♥ Q 9 4 3
♦ K J 5
♣ 10 6 4 2

♠ A Q J 6 5 2
♥ K 8 2
♦ Q
♣ A 8 5

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1NT	Pass	3♠
Pass	4♠	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♦[2]	Pass	6♠
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 0 or 3 key cards

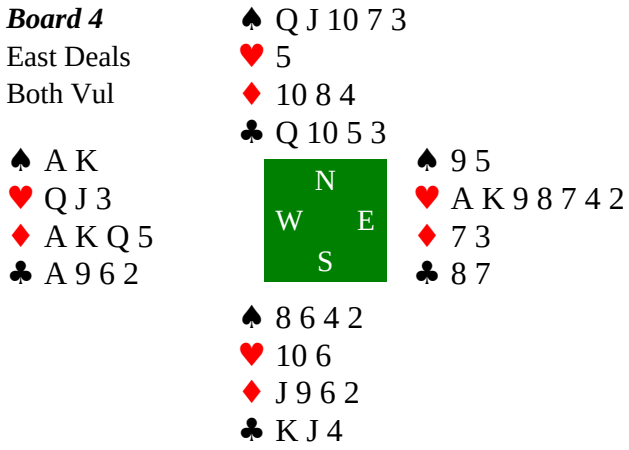
6♠ by South
Lead: ♣Q

When SOUTH makes a slam try with a jump to 3♠, the best approach for NORTH is to agree on the trump suit immediately but indicate a minimum hand by bidding 4♠.

SOUTH's next move is logical; RKCB 4NT.

NORTH shows zero or three Key Cards, and since it could not possibly be zero, SOUTH knows they are the ♠K and both red Aces. Even possessing all the Key Cards SOUTH knows there aren't enough points for a Grand slam.

Board 4
East Deals
Both Vul



West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		3♥	Pass
4NT[1]	Pass	5♥[2]	Pass
7NT			
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 2 key cards without the trump queen

7NT by West
Lead: ♠Q

It is usually not recommended to use any form of Blackwood when you have a suit with two quick losers, but WEST knows EAST would not preempt with a 10-high ♥ suit.

EAST's reply to RKCB is 5♥, showing two Key Cards. WEST knows they are the ♥A ♥K so she can count thirteen tricks.

She bids a confident 7NT (and hopes EAST didn't open 3♥ with a 6-card suit.

Board 5
North Deals
None Vul

	♠ Q 10 8 7 5 ♥ K 6 ♦ A K 3 ♣ A K J	
♠ K ♥ J 9 7 5 4 ♦ 10 8 6 5 ♣ 9 8 7		♠ A 2 ♥ 10 8 2 ♦ J 9 4 2 ♣ 10 6 4 2
	♠ J 9 6 4 3 ♥ A Q 3 ♦ Q 7 ♣ Q 5 3	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♠	Pass	3♠
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♣[2]
Pass	5♠		
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 1 or 4 key cards

5♠ by North
Lead: ♣4

NORTH has 21 points, and when she hears SOUTH make a limit raise she tries for slam with RKCB.

SOUTH answers with just one Key Card so NORTH stops at 5♠, knowing they are missing two Key Cards.

Of course she didn't expect the two missing Key Cards to be the Ace and King of trumps!